

The Last Lighthouse

A Short Story in Five Chapters

On a quiet island where the sea met the sky, an old lighthouse stood alone on a cliff. For years, its light had guided ships home. But one winter night, something unexpected arrived.

Chapter 1: The Strange Light

Mira lived with her grandfather, the lighthouse keeper. Every evening, she climbed the winding stairs to help him light the great lamp. One stormy night, just before midnight, Mira saw a second light far out at sea. It flashed three times, disappeared, and then flashed again.

Her grandfather looked through his telescope and became unusually quiet. "That is no ship," he said. "And it is coming closer."

Chapter 2: The Message

The next morning, Mira found a small wooden box washed onto the shore. Inside was a silver compass and a piece of paper covered with a single sentence: *When the lighthouse goes dark, follow the light.*

That evening, the storm returned. The waves crashed against the rocks, and suddenly the lighthouse lamp went out. In the darkness, the mysterious light appeared again beyond the cliffs.

Chapter 3: Beyond the Cliffs

Mira took the compass and followed the strange light along a narrow path. It led her to a hidden cove where an old wooden boat rested on the sand. Inside the boat was a young sailor named Elias, who had been separated from his crew during the storm.

Elias explained that his ship had lost its way. The strange light had guided him toward the island, but without the lighthouse, he could not find the safe passage home.

Chapter 4: The Choice

Mira knew the lighthouse could not be repaired before the storm became worse. Then she remembered the silver compass. Its needle pointed not north, but toward the distant flashing light.

She and Elias climbed the cliff together. At the top, they discovered an old emergency lantern. Using oil from the lighthouse storehouse, Mira lit it and placed it at the highest window.

The mysterious light answered with three flashes. Then, through the storm, a ship appeared.

Chapter 5: Home

The ship followed the lantern and safely reached the island's harbor. Elias was reunited with his crew, and the lighthouse was repaired the following week.

Years later, Mira became the new lighthouse keeper. Whenever storms came, she remembered that night and the message in the wooden box. She finally understood its meaning: sometimes, when the path you know disappears, you must trust the smallest light you can find.

— The End —